

FUTURE

1. Passage anchor

> “In the **future**, I hope I can pass that on to other people as well...”

Passage meaning

future = the time that comes after the present

未來；將來

Here, the speaker is talking about what they hope to do later in life.

Practice

1. In the **future**, I'd like to mentor younger students.

將來，我想指導比我年輕的學生。

2. She hopes to work in education in the **future**.

她希望**未來**能從事教育工作。

Core meanings of FUTURE

2. future — the time after now

= the period of time that comes after the present

未來；將來

This is the central noun meaning and the passage sense.

Examples

1. No one knows exactly what the **future** will bring.

沒有人知道**未來**究竟會帶來什麼。

2. We need to think about the **future**.

我們需要思考**未來**。

3. in the future

= at some later time; from now onward

將來；未來

Examples

1. I hope to travel more **in the future**.
我希望**未來**能多旅行。
2. Please be more careful **in the future**.
以後請更小心一點。

Important nuance

Depending on context, **in the future** can mean:

- * at some later point
- * from now on

4. the near future

= a time not far from now
不久的將來；近期

Examples

1. We have no plans to move in the **near future**.
我們在**近期**沒有搬家的計畫。
2. The company expects further growth in the **near future**.
公司預期在**不久的將來**還會繼續成長。

5. the distant future

= a time far ahead
遙遠的未來

Examples

1. It is difficult to predict the **distant future**.
很難預測**遙遠的未來**。
2. The technology may become common in the **distant future**.
這項技術也許會在**更遙遠的未來**普及。

Personal future

6. someone's future

= the life, career, opportunities, or circumstances that lie ahead for a person

****某人的未來；前途****

Examples

1. She is thinking seriously about her ****future****.
她正在認真思考自己的****未來****。
2. His teachers were optimistic about his ****future****.
老師們對他的****前途****很有信心。

7. a bright future

= a future with strong prospects for success or happiness

****光明的前途；美好的未來****

Examples

1. She has a ****bright future**** ahead of her.
她有一個****光明的前途****。
2. The young athlete seems to have a ****bright future****.
那名年輕運動員似乎有很****光明的前景****。

8. no future

= no realistic prospect of success, development, or continuation

****沒有前途；沒有未來****

Examples

1. He felt the job offered him ****no future****.
他覺得這份工作****沒有前途****。
2. A relationship without trust has little ****future****.
一段沒有信任的關係很難有什麼****未來****。

Expected development or prospects

9. future — prospects or likely development

= what is likely to happen to a person, organization, idea, industry, etc. later

****前景；未來發展****

Examples

1. The ****future of the industry**** depends on innovation.
這個產業的****未來發展****取決於創新。
2. There is uncertainty about the ****future of the project****.
這個專案的****未來前景****仍不明朗。

10. the future of something

= what will happen to something later

****.....的未來；.....的前景****

Examples

1. The debate focused on the ****future of education****.
辯論聚焦於****教育的未來****。
2. Technology will influence the ****future of work****.
科技將影響****工作的未來形態****。

Adjective meanings

11. future — happening or existing later

= relating to a time after the present

****未來的；將來的****

Examples

1. We need to prepare for ****future challenges****.
我們需要為****未來的挑戰****做好準備。

2. This decision may affect **future generations**.

這項決定可能影響**未來世代**。

12. future plans

= plans for a later time

未來計畫；將來的打算

Examples

1. She asked about my **future plans**.

她問了我的**未來計畫**。

2. We discussed our **future plans** over dinner.

我們吃晚餐時討論了**未來的打算**。

13. future generations

= people who will live after the present generation

後代；未來世代

Examples

1. We should protect the environment for **future generations**.

我們應該為**未來世代**保護環境。

2. These decisions will affect **future generations**.

這些決定會影響**後代**。

14. future employer / partner / leader

= someone who will later have a particular role

未來的雇主 / 伴侶 / 領導者

Examples

1. A **future employer** may ask for references.

未來的雇主可能會要求推薦資料。

2. She could become a **future leader** in the field.

她未來可能成為這個領域的**領導者**。

Grammar sense

15. future — grammatical time reference

In grammar, **future** refers to ways of talking about events after the present.

未來時間；**未來語意**

Examples

1. English expresses the **future** in several different ways.

英語可以用多種方式表達**未來時間**。

2. “Will” is commonly used to talk about the **future**.

will 常用來談論**未來**。

16. future tense

= a grammatical tense or form used to refer to future time

未來式

Examples

1. Students often learn the **future tense** early.

學生通常很早就會學到**未來式**。

2. Not every language has a separate grammatical **future tense**.

並非每種語言都有獨立的**未來時態**。

Important learner note

In English grammar, teachers often use the label **future tense**, but future meaning is actually expressed through several constructions:

* will

* be going to

* present continuous

* simple present in schedules

Financial meaning

17. futures — contracts for future delivery or settlement

Plural **futures** can refer to financial contracts in which assets are bought or sold at an agreed price for settlement later.

期貨

Examples

1. Oil **futures** rose sharply.
石油**期貨**大幅上漲。
2. He works in the **futures market**.
他在**期貨市場**工作。

This is a genuinely distinct financial meaning.

18. futures market

= market where futures contracts are traded

期貨市場

Examples

1. Prices moved quickly in the **futures market**.
期貨市場的價格快速變動。
2. Commodity **futures markets** can be volatile.
商品**期貨市場**可能波動很大。

Future as a possible outcome

19. future — possible continuation or survival

= whether something is likely to continue to exist or succeed

未來；存續前景

Examples

1. The club's **future** is uncertain.

這個俱樂部的**存續前景**不明朗。

2. Funding will determine the program's **future**.

資金將決定這個計畫的**未來**。

Common expressions

20. for the future

= for use, consideration, or benefit later

為了未來；留作日後

Examples

1. We need to save more **for the future**.

我們需要為**未來**多存一點錢。

2. Keep these notes **for future reference**.

保留這些筆記以供**日後參考**。

21. for future reference

= so that something can be remembered or used later

供日後參考；以後要記得

Examples

1. **For future reference**, please send the form by email.

以後請注意，請用電子郵件寄送表格。

2. Save the instructions **for future reference**.

保存這些說明以供**日後參考**。

Very common fixed expression.

22. in future

Especially in British English:

= from now on

****今後；以後****

Examples

1. ****In future****, please arrive on time.

****今後****請準時到。

2. I'll be more careful ****in future****.

我****以後****會更小心。

Important contrast

****in future****

= from now on

****in the future****

= at some later time / in future time generally

The distinction is especially noticeable in British English.

23. from now on

Very close to ****in future****:

= beginning now and continuing afterward

****從現在起；今後****

Example

I'll double-check everything ****from now on****.

我****從現在起****會把所有事情再確認一次。

24. in the foreseeable future

= within a period ahead that can reasonably be predicted

****可預見的未來****

Examples

1. The policy is unlikely to change in the ****foreseeable future****.

這項政策在****可預見的未來****不太可能改變。

2. We expect demand to remain strong for the ****foreseeable future****.
我們預期需求在****可預見的未來****仍會保持強勁。

25. future-proof

= designed to remain useful despite future developments or changes
****具未來適應性的；防止快速過時的****

Examples

1. The company wants to ****future-proof**** its systems.
公司希望讓其系統具備****應對未來變化的能力****。
2. Flexible design can help ****future-proof**** a building.
彈性設計可以讓建築更能****適應未來需求****。

Modern and useful business/technology term.

Related forms

26. futuristic

= looking, sounding, or seeming as though it belongs to the future
****未來感的；超前的****

Examples

1. The building has a ****futuristic design****.
那棟建築有很強的****未來感設計****。
2. The car's interior looks ****futuristic****.
這輛車的內裝看起來很有****未來感****。

27. futurist

A. person who studies or predicts future trends

****未來學家****

B. historically, member of an artistic movement called Futurism

****未來主義者****

Examples

1. A ****futurist**** spoke about changes in work and technology.
一位****未來學家****談到工作與科技的變化。
2. Some early twentieth-century artists were ****Futurists****.
二十世紀初有些藝術家是****未來主義者****。

28. futurism

A. study/thinking focused on future developments

****未來學；未來思潮****

B. the historical Futurist art movement

****未來主義****

This is lower-priority for general learners but a legitimate family extension.

High-value collocations

29. future career

= career someone may have later

****未來職涯****

Examples

1. The course may help with your ****future career****.
這門課可能對你的****未來職涯****有幫助。
2. She is thinking about her ****future career****.
她正在思考自己的****未來職業方向****。

30. future success

= success that may occur later

****未來的成功****

Examples

1. Good habits can contribute to ****future success****.
良好習慣可以促成****未來的成功****。
2. Education can create opportunities for ****future success****.
教育可以為****未來成功****創造機會。

31. future prospects

= chances of future success, development, or employment

****未來前景；發展前途****

Examples

1. The qualification may improve your ****future prospects****.
這項資格可能改善你的****未來前景****。
2. She was worried about her ****future prospects****.
她擔心自己的****前途****。

32. plan for the future

= prepare for later needs or events

****規劃未來****

Examples

1. Young people are encouraged to ****plan for the future****.
年輕人被鼓勵要****規劃未來****。
2. We need to ****plan for the future****, not just solve today's problems.
我們需要****規劃未來****，而不是只處理今天的問題。

33. look to the future

= focus on what will happen or what can be achieved later

****展望未來；著眼未來****

Examples

1. After the setback, the team decided to ****look to the future****.

經歷挫折後，團隊決定****展望未來****。

2. We should learn from the past but ****look to the future****.

我們應從過去學習，但也要****著眼未來****。

Key contrasts

34. future vs forthcoming

****future****

= relating generally to time after now

****未來的****

****forthcoming****

= expected or scheduled to happen relatively soon

****即將到來的****

Compare:

> ****future developments****

> 未來發展

> the ****forthcoming meeting****

> 即將舉行的會議

35. future vs upcoming

****upcoming****

= happening soon

****即將到來的****

****future****

= any later time, near or distant

****未來的****

Compare:

- * upcoming exam = 即將到來的考試
- * future exams = 未來所有可能的考試

36. future vs prospect

****future****

= what lies ahead

****prospect****

= possibility or expectation of a particular future outcome

****前景；可能性****

Compare:

> She worries about her ****future****.

> 她擔心自己的未來。

> Her employment ****prospects**** are good.

> 她的就業****前景****很好。

37. future vs destiny

****future****

= what will happen later, without necessarily implying inevitability

****未來****

****destiny****

= events believed to be predetermined or inevitable

****命運；宿命****

The words should not be treated as synonyms.

38. future vs later

****future****

is a noun/adjective referring broadly to time after now.

****later****

is usually an adverb/adjective meaning after the present or after another time.

Compare:

> I'll do it **later**.

> 我晚點做。

> I hope to do it **in the future**.

> 我希望將來能做。

Later often points to a more specific relative time.

Countability

39. the future — usually singular and uncountable-like

For general future time:

* the future

* in the future

Not normally:

* **a future** when merely meaning future time

Example

We cannot predict **the future**.

我們無法預測**未來**。

40. a future — possible life/prospect

a future is possible when meaning a particular prospect or continued existence.

Examples

1. She has **a future in medicine**.

她在醫學領域**很有前途**。

2. Does this relationship really have **a future**?

這段關係真的**有未來嗎**？

This is a useful countability shift.

Meaning map

The central concept of **future** is:

time or development that lies ahead

From that develop several branches:

Time

the future

→ **未來**

Personal prospects

someone's future

→ **前途**

Likely development

future of an industry

→ **未來發展；前景**

Adjective

future plans / future generations

→ **未來的**

Grammar

future tense

→ **未來式**

Finance

futures

→ **期貨**

The common thread is usually **what comes later**, except the financial plural **futures**, which has become a specialized lexical meaning.

Passage recap

> “In the **future**, I hope I can pass that on to other people as well...”

Here:

future = **the time after the present**

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* **未來**

* **將來**

* contextually: **將來**，我也希望能把這份影響傳遞給其他人

MCQ-ready meaning

future in the passage

= **the time that comes after now**

未來；將來

It does not mean **future prospects / 前途** specifically here, although that is another very common meaning.

High-value distinction

* **in the future** = 在未來；將來

* **in future** = 今後；從現在起

* **a future** = 前途；未來可能性

* **futures** = 期貨

MCQ-ready list — FUTURE

the time after the present — 未來；將來

in the future

someone's later life or prospects — 前途；未來發展

She has a bright future.

what will happen to or become of something — 未來；前景；未來發展

the future of education

happening or existing at a later time (adj.) — 未來的；將來的

future plans / future generations

a possible successful continuation or prospect (a future) — 前途；發展可能性

He has a future in medicine.

future time in grammar — 未來時間；未來式

future tense / future forms

futures (finance) — 期貨

oil futures / futures market

Key expression distinctions

in the future — 將來；在未來

in future — 今後；從現在起（尤其英式英文）

near future — 不久的將來；近期

distant future — 遙遠的未來

foreseeable future — 可預見的未來

bright future — 光明的前途

future prospects — 未來前景

for future reference — 供日後參考

Passage answer

“In the future, I hope I can pass that on...”

future = the time after the present → 未來；將來

And yes — the full MCQ-ready list should be a standard section in every entry, not just a single passage-sense line. I'll keep that format going forward.